

smoothing disabled by default. If you are accustomed to cooler or bluish-white tones, the Movie preset might feel a tad yellowish at the start.

The alternative is the standard mode that has cool whites. This is a boosted mode with vibrant colours and options like motion clarity (or smoothing) and Dynamic Contrast enabled by default, often resulting in unpredictable and inaccurate results.

The Movie mode by default over-tracks standard gamma slightly. This is why just reducing the gamma point by 1 results in better accuracy. For SDR content, the colour accuracy is excellent. Skin tones, colours of the sky, and foliage appear natural. Using our SpectraCal C6 HDR2000 colorimeter, VideoForge Pro pattern generator and Calman Ultimate software, we measured an average Delta error of just 1.9 which lies below the humanly perceptible level of 3. The maximum delta error is just 4.2, which is the best we have recorded in the segment. We recorded a contrast of 4301:1 for the VA panel. In our tests, the TV covered 100% of the sRGB colour space (Standard mode) and 91% of DCI-P3, which is again above average. In our test patterns, we noticed slight oversharpening but this wasn't very apparent in the content we played.

Upscaling performance is about average and artefacts are quite prominent when playing low-resolution legacy content. We also noticed screen uniformity issues that are commonly associated with LCD TVs and may vary from one unit to another.

HDR PERFORMANCE

All popular Smart TV formats including Dolby Vision, HDR10+, HDR10 and HLG are supported on this TV. Of these, Dolby Vision and HDR10+ are advanced HDR format that allows content creators to adjust content settings on a scene-by-scene or even frame-by-frame basis, thus resulting in a more impactful HDR representation. Once again, the HDR performance exceeded our expectations in terms of colour accuracy and overall representation.

To start with, we measured a peak brightness of 472 Nits which is higher than what we usually see in this price segment. In the movie mode, the TV mostly tracks EOTF diligently with a slight dip of around 60% luminance and finally rolling off at around 370 nits.

The colour accuracy is also impressive. We recorded an average Delta error of 3.4 with a higher error in saturated colour tones. In our perceptual testing, skin tones and colours appeared quite natural and the details were reasonably good.

In Dolby Vision, motion clarity is enabled by default in all presets which induces a slight soap opera effect. You can disable it from the picture mode settings. The TV supports a BT2020 colour volume of 65.88 in XY terms and 72.26 in UV terms, which is only average.

GAMING AND AUDIO

The TV comes with a number of features for gamers including ALLM to automatically switch to game mode when a compatible gaming device is connected, HGIG mode for accurate HDR tone mapping, and a gamebar with useful tools that you can summon by long pressing the settings button. Another interesting feature of this TV is the 120 Hz game accelerator that is based on TCL's proprietary Dual Line Gate technology that allows the 60 Hz panel to display 120 frames per second. This helps improve the gaming experience by reducing motion blur and tearing. This feature works only with console gaming. There's also AMD FreeSync to enhance the fluidity of the gameplay by eliminating undesirable artefacts such as screen tearing and stuttering.

In our testing, the TV felt fast and responsive while gaming in the 'fast' mode. We did notice some random screen tearing artefacts in FPS games but nothing that hampered our gaming experience. The colours in SDR and HDR games felt accurate in perceptual testing.

As for audio, the 56W speakers can get astonishingly loud. Dolby Atmos experience is not very convincing, though - which is to be expected of native TV speakers. The good thing is that you can easily switch sound presets according to

the content you are watching and enhance your experience.

VERDICT

TCL 55-inch T6G QLED TV turned out to be a surprisingly impressive option in its segment. The TV combines an attractive design, is feature-packed and comes with a colour-accurate movie mode for SDR and HDR content. For gamers, the TCL 55T6G offers several features like ALLM, HGIG mode, and a 120 Hz game accelerator that elevates the gaming experience with the latest-generation consoles.

The software has some really useful extras but it is also loaded with proprietary TCL services that aren't as useful and get in the way. Of course, the price entails some limitations like some minor screen uniformity issues and the available dynamic range for HDR but overall, if you are looking for an option that offers great picture quality on a budget for entertainment and gaming we can recommend the TCL T6G QLED TV as an option.

The TCL 55T6G offers a good quality QLED display for a very competitive price. This means its backlight coupled with Quantum Dot Enhancement Film can produce good quality white light resulting in higher colour volume compared to conventional LED LCD TVs. TCL claims 94% coverage of DCI-P3 standard which means your HDR content will look vivid and appealing, just as the creator intended.

—Deepak Singh

SPECIFICATIONS

Panel Size: 55-inch | Panel Type: QLED | Panel Resolution: 3840 x 2160 - 4K UHD | Panel Refresh Rate: 60Hz | Supported HDR Formats: Dolby Vision, HDR10+, HDR10, HLG | Speakers: 56W | Audio formats: Supports Dolby Audio, DTS VirtualX, DTS-HD | Software: Fire OS 7 | HDMI Ports: 3x HDMI 2.1 | HDMI Features: ALLM, eARC | Other connectivity options: one USB port, Dual-band Wi-Fi, Optical input, Bluetooth Ethernet, Antenna input, AV in adapter, Headphone out | Processor: 64-bit Quad Core Processor | Built-in RAM and storage: 2GB + 16GB

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